CUSTOMER RESEARCH & PRODUCT ROADMAP

Customer & MVP Blueprint

Framework: Lean MVP Architecture

Target Sector: Hybrid Fast-Casual Food

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This blueprint translates validation insights into a highly tactical product development roadmap. The objective is to build a tech-enabled, fast-casual restaurant venture in urban India that fills the market gap between budget unorganized food shops and premium global QSR networks. Rather than deploying critical seed capital into long-term brick-and-mortar leases immediately, this blueprint prioritizes a targeted Minimum Viable Product (MVP) model designed to mathematically prove unit economics, customer acquisition velocity, and product-market fit using unbiased consumer transactions.

2. IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

- **Target Cohort:** Urban white-collar professionals, university students, and modern young family configurations (Ages 18–35) clustered around tier-1 corporate tech corridors and high-density education zones.
- **Socio-Economic Bracket:** SEC A and B1 classification; individual monthly income dynamics of ₹45,000–₹90,000.
- **Core Behavioral Affinity:** Digital-first paradigm; heavy users of instant-delivery platforms (3+ times per week); highly sensitive to food cleanliness, but demands strong structural price-to-volume value.

3. BUYER PERSONA

Metric / Segment	Persona Mapping Detail
Persona Identifier	Rohan S., "The Value-Conscious Professional"
Demographics	26 Years Old, Single, Resident Senior Software Engineer within an urban technology cluster.
Core Intent & Goals	Seeks access to absolutely clean, fresh, and appetizing daily meals without depleting his disposable income or encroaching on tight work schedules.
Primary Friction	Experiences recurring digestive tracking layout issues from nearby street vendors, but views international fast-food brands as financially restrictive for long-term recurring options.

4. TOP 10 CUSTOMER PAIN POINTS

1. **Gastrointestinal Health Risks:** High incidence of foodborne illnesses arising from compromised water and ingredient sanitation in unorganized local kitchens.
2. **The "Premium Price Trap":** Being forced to absorb a 40%–60% margin premium at global chains exclusively to buy basic health safety assurance.
3. **Lunch-Hour Time Friction:** Inefficient kitchen assembly patterns causing service delays that run past standard 45-minute company break constraints.

4. **Substandard Delivery Packaging:** Fragile container structures that result in food arriving cold, compressed, or structurally spilled.
5. **Unwelcoming On-Site Ambiance:** Budget-conscious restaurants featuring uninviting, dirty, or claustrophobic seating environments unsuitable for group business lunches.
6. **Menu Inelasticity:** Rapid customer fatigue caused by static, poorly structured menu selections at mid-market eateries.
7. **Heavy Preservative Profiles:** Deep reliance on frozen, highly processed inventory lines by legacy chains to bypass operational supply-chain steps.
8. **Opaque Delivery Fees:** Surprise inflation of final check-out sizes via excessive packaging fees, peak surge taxes, and delivery app platform margins.
9. **Nutritional Ambiguity:** Zero consumer insight into underlying macronutrient breakdowns, sodium usage, or cooking oil freshness metrics.
10. **Fragmented Customer Care:** Complete absence of programmatic appreciation or customer retention protocols for high-frequency daily diners.

5. CUSTOMER JOURNEY MAP

Awareness	Consideration	Purchase	Retention
Discovery driven by hyper-localized social media video campaigns showcasing pristine open kitchens.	Evaluates real consumer pictures, sanitation indicators, and pricing sheets across Google Maps/Zomato.	Processes transaction seamlessly through a dedicated QR or conversational WhatsApp-native framework.	Receives automated WhatsApp-driven engagement offering customized multi-meal subscription discounts.

6. KEY CUSTOMER OBJECTIONS & BUYING TRIGGERS

Key Customer Objections & Mitigations

- **Objection:** *"If your prices match local streetside shops, you must be using low-quality oils or expired items."*
  Mitigation: Implement a clean, physical open glass architectural line and publish real-time source logs on digital platforms.
- **Objection:** *"Will budget-friendly pricing result in an unstable, unpolished seating area?"*
  Mitigation: Implement minimalist space-saving interiors that reduce real estate square-footage needs while presenting an elevated aesthetic.
- **Objection:** *"Will my delivery items arrive messy or completely cold?"*
  Mitigation: Source customized multi-layered thermal containers with integrated moisture ventilation.

Key Buying Triggers

- **Mid-Week Domestic Fatigue:** Sudden exhaustion of energy reserves to prepare meals at home following extended late-night office delivery deadlines.
- **Corporate Team Lunch Allocation:** Casual peer groups coordinating collective lunch choices under explicit budget caps and high hygiene expectations.
- **Weather Disruptions:** Monsoonal or temperature anomalies shifting localized consumer behavior entirely toward hyper-local delivery apps.

7. MVP RECOMMENDATION

Core Strategy: The 3-Day Weekend Pilot
Launch a 3-Day Pop-Up operation running directly out of a fully compliant, rented commercial dark-kitchen hub. Limit baseline scope to 5–8 high-margin, fast-moving items sharing a tightly consolidated raw material index. Utilize an automated WhatsApp Business portal to execute orders directly.

- **What NOT to build yet:** Do not enter multi-year real estate commercial lease terms. Do not fund native iOS/Android client applications. Do not develop an expansive menu catalog.
- **Success Targets:** Achieve Gross Material Margins ≥ 60% after precise ingredient/packaging tracking; maintain a Net Promoter Score (NPS) ≥ 50 across 60+ unique unaligned cold transactions; achieve an organic re-order rate ≥ 20% over the brief validation window.

8. MOSCOW PRIORITIZATION BLUEPRINT

MUST HAVE	SHOULD HAVE
• FSSAI structural kitchen license clearance. • 5-item consolidated ingredient menu sheet. • Integrated cross-compatible UPI digital payout framework. • Leak-proof ventilated custom storage containers.	• Automated WhatsApp ordering system. • Live streaming display showcasing kitchen sanitation. • QR-code menu routing structures for walk-ins.
COULD HAVE	**WON'T HAVE (For MVP)**
• Custom-branded corporate meal box configurations. • Instagrammable vertical garden walls in the pickup lobby.	• Proprietary native application installations. • Centralized bulk prep warehouses. • Multi-market expansion strategy deployment.

9. PRICING HYPOTHESIS & TOP 5 RISKS

Pricing Architecture: Target an Average Order Value (AOV) of ₹240–₹280 ($2.85–$3.35 USD) per combo box layout. This penetration framework prices the offering 35% below premium casual restaurants while preserving a 25% premium above unorganized shops to support a 60%+ gross operational margin.

Identified Risk Factor	Threat Tier	Institutional Mitigation Strategy Document
1. High Early Capital Bleed	HIGH	Restrict initial validation strictly to short-term equipment and shared spaces.
2. Platform Aggregator Commission Friction	HIGH	Drive consumers directly to internal WhatsApp ordering via targeted loyalty points.
3. High Kitchen Labor Attrition	MEDIUM	Standardize centralized dry spice mix assembly to eliminate chef scaling risk.
4. Raw Material Shrinkage & Waste	HIGH	Enforce high menu overlap so ingredients are continuously turned over.
5. Brand Commodity Risks	MEDIUM	Lead the core messaging strategy around validated kitchen clinical safety scores.

10. 30-DAY MVP PLAN & FOUNDER ACTION SHEET

Timeline Schedule:
Days 1–7: Finalize exact recipe weight distributions down to the gram.
Days 8–14: Secure shared-kitchen lease terms and deploy hyper-local targeted geo-marketing.
Days 15–21: Run the live 3-day weekend pilot; monitor actual product preparation times.
Days 22–30: Process NPS metrics, map out core economic profiles, and adjust location parameters.

Founder Action Sheet Checklist

□ Calculate baseline cost metrics per gram for all 5 core menu selections.

□ Collect structural manufacturing estimates from 3 packaging distribution hubs.

□ Submit formal online application filings for the mandatory FSSAI operational license.

□ Build the conversational product library structure inside the WhatsApp Business panel.

□ Execute formal rental agreements for the short-term weekend commercial workspace.

□ Deploy a micro-budget of ₹5,000 for hyper-targeted local social media advertisements.

□ Distribute informational QR flyers to corporate reception spaces in the target hub.

□ Standardize assembly operations with 2 temporary, on-demand line cooks.

□ Deploy digital feedback links instantly post-delivery to map consumer NPS.

□ Audit raw material wastage data against actual cash balances on Day 30.

11. STRATEGIC PERFORMANCE MATRIX

Customer Clarity:	85/100
Problem Severity:	75/100
PMF Potential:	80/100
MVP Readiness:	90/100

12. FINAL VERDICT

🟡 Promising but Unvalidated Investment Profile

The underlying structural opportunity within the mid-tier urban Indian food service ecosystem exhibits exceptional secular macro tailwinds. However, current feedback channels remain restricted to personal networks, which introduces validation bias. To justify larger capital investments, the founder must execute this 30-day MVP plan to generate objective, data-backed transaction logs with paying strangers before securing long-term storefront infrastructure.